DECODE UPSC with Mounika

November 2nd Week 2026: Practice Set

14 Prelims MCQs · 1 Mains question with answer outline · Mon 9 – Sat 14 Nov 2026

How to use: attempt all 14 in 14 minutes, then check the key. Then write the Mains answer: 250 words in 11 minutes.

Part A · Prelims MCQs

1. Inflation

Consider the following statements:
1. Consumer price inflation data is released by the Reserve Bank of India.
2. Under flexible inflation targeting, 6% is the upper tolerance limit.
3. If average inflation stays outside the band for three consecutive quarters, the RBI must report to the Government.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

2. Women's reservation and delimitation

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the statements below?
Statement-I: The 131st Amendment Bill failed in April 2026 though more members voted for it than against it.
Statement-II: A constitutional amendment needs a majority of the total membership and two-thirds of those present and voting.

(a) Both correct, II explains I (b) Both correct, II does not explain I (c) Only I correct (d) Only II correct

3. Delhi's air

Consider the following statements:
1. An Air Quality Index of 401–450 falls in the "severe" category.
2. India's 24-hour standard for PM2.5 is 60 micrograms per cubic metre.
3. The Graded Response Action Plan is enforced by the Commission for Air Quality Management.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

4. TB

Which one of the following about TB is correct (WHO Global TB Report 2026)?
(a) India's TB cases fell 38% since 2015.
(b) India accounts for about a quarter of the world's TB cases.
(c) The Sustainable Development Goal to end TB is 2025.
(d) India is not among the high multidrug-resistant TB countries.

5. Exports

Consider the following statements about October 2026:
1. India's merchandise exports reached a record monthly high.
2. India ran a surplus in goods trade.
3. A surplus in services narrowed the overall trade deficit.
4. India is the largest receiver of remittances in the world.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

6. Poverty

The global Multidimensional Poverty Index is published by:
(a) the World Bank
(b) the United Nations Development Programme with Oxford
(c) the International Monetary Fund
(d) NITI Aayog

7. Cabinet decisions

Consider the following statements:
1. Stand-Up India supports new enterprises with loans of ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore.
2. Urea is covered under the nutrient-based subsidy.
3. The Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units backs small Mudra loans.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

8. Battery black mass

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade works under the Ministry of:
(a) Mines
(b) Commerce and Industry
(c) Environment, Forest and Climate Change
(d) Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

9. Adaptation Gap

How many of the following pairs (report — publisher) are correctly matched?
1. Emissions Gap Report — United Nations Environment Programme
2. Adaptation Gap Report — United Nations Environment Programme
3. Global Tuberculosis Report — World Health Organization

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

10. Siang river

How many of the following pairs (name of the river — region) are correctly matched?
1. Yarlung Tsangpo — Tibet
2. Siang — Arunachal Pradesh
3. Jamuna — Assam

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

11. Ninth Schedule

Consider the following statements about the Ninth Schedule:
1. It was added by the First Amendment in 1951.
2. Laws placed in it are fully immune from judicial review.
3. A state legislature can place its own law in it.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

12. Exercises

How many of the following pairs (exercise — partner) are correctly matched?
1. IMNEX — Myanmar
2. SLINEX — Sri Lanka
3. Mitra Shakti — Sri Lanka
4. Malabar — India, United States, Japan, Australia

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

13. Days

Consider the following statements:
1. India celebrates Children’s Day on Jawaharlal Nehru’s birthday, 14 November.
2. The United Nations’ Universal Children’s Day is on 20 November.
3. National Education Day marks the birthday of Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan.

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

14. Persons and places in news

How many of the following pairs are correctly matched?
1. Anuj Shrivatri — India’s 100th chess Grandmaster
2. M. John Harrison — Booker Prize 2026

3. Mekedatu — river Krishna
4. Shenzhen — APEC leaders 2026

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

Answer key with reasons

Q	Answer	Why
1	(b) Only two	The Statistics Ministry (National Statistics Office) releases CPI data.
2	(a) Both correct, and II explains I	298 was short of two-thirds of those voting.
3	(c) All three	All three are correct.
4	(b)	The 38% fall is in deaths, not cases; the SDG year is 2030.
5	(c) Only three	India ran a goods trade deficit of about $40 billion.
6	(b)	NITI Aayog publishes the national index; the World Bank measures income and spending.
7	(b) Only two	Urea has its own controlled price.
8	(b)	It banned black-mass exports under the 1992 foreign trade law.
9	(c) All three	All three are correctly matched.
10	(b) Only two	The Jamuna is the name in Bangladesh; in Assam it is the Brahmaputra.
11	(a) Only one	I.R. Coelho (2007) allows basic-structure review; only Parliament can add laws.
12	(d) All four	All four are correctly matched.
13	(b) Only two	National Education Day is for Maulana Abul Kalam Azad.
14	(c) Only three	Mekedatu is on the Cauvery, not the Krishna.

Part B · Mains question with answer outline

GS-2 · 15 marks · 250 words: Should Lok Sabha seat shares stay frozen to protect states that controlled population? Discuss with reference to women’s reservation and delimitation.

- **Introduction:**
  - Articles 81 and 82 tie seats to population.
  - The 84th Amendment (2001) froze seat shares until the first census after 2026.
  - Under Article 334A, the 106th Amendment’s one-third reservation for women starts only after delimitation.
- **Arguments for continuing the freeze:**
  - It rewards states that controlled population (mostly southern).
  - It protects federal balance.
  - It avoids a large shift of political weight to a few states.
- **Arguments against:**

    - “One person, one vote”: voters in fast-growing states are under-represented.
    - Women’s reservation stays blocked while delimitation waits.
    - The April 2026 bill (298–230) shows the deadlock.
- **Middle paths:**
    - Enlarge the House (543 → up to 850) so that no state loses seats.
    - Delink women’s reservation from delimitation.
    - Strengthen the Rajya Sabha’s federal role.
    - Weigh population with other criteria.
- **Conclusion:** representation needs both equality of votes and federal trust. Build consensus through the Inter-State Council or an all-party process before any special session.

All facts are verified in the research brief. All questions are practice questions written for this channel, not previous-year questions.